

Nearly grown up

After baby birds have left home they are called fledglings. Many are eaten by cats and hawks, but some from each nest survive and have families of their own.



Feed me!

Most nestlings are helpless when they hatch; they are blind and naked. All they can do is eat and grow.



The parents push food into their chicks' bright, begging beaks.

Fast food

Blue tits bring back more than 1,000 juicy caterpillars and aphids to the nest each day for their hungry chicks.



Caterpillar

Ducks' eyes are open when they are born.



The wet, sticky fluff, or down, soon dries out.



After the chick has pushed itself head-first out of the egg, it is very tired.

This egg tooth falls off after a few days.



Follow the leader

Baby ducks follow the first big, moving thing that they see—usually one of their parents. This instinct is called imprinting.

Like most waterbirds, just one hour after hatching this duckling can walk, see, swim, and feed itself.

